

Birth Plan & Birth Preferences Workbook

A thoughtful space to organize your preferences,
questions, and plans for your birth experience.

MY BIRTH JOURNEY

Name: _____

Estimated Due Date: _____

Birth Location: _____

A birth plan is a communication tool. Your preferences may change as labor unfolds, and your healthcare team may need to adapt the plan based on your circumstances and hospital policies.

How to Use This Workbook

Use these pages to think through what matters to you, record questions for your healthcare team, and create a clear summary of your preferences. Bring your completed plan to your prenatal appointments and birth location.

- A few helpful reminders**
- ☐ Your preferences are personal and may change at any time.

☐ Discuss your preferences with your healthcare team before labor whenever possible.

☐ Hospital, birth center, and local policies can affect what is available.

☐ Keep a copy that is easy for your support person and care team to access.

☐ This workbook is an organizational tool, not medical advice.

My notes

My Birth Preferences at a Glance

Use this page for the most important points you want your support person and healthcare team to know.

What Matters Most to Me	My Top Priorities
■ Feeling informed and involved in decisions	■ Communication
■ A calm and supportive environment	■ Comfort
■ Freedom to ask questions	■ Movement
■ Having my support person involved	■ Privacy
■ Being flexible if circumstances change	■ Newborn bonding

Additional priorities or requests

My Hospital / Birth Location

Birth Location Details	Planning Details
☐ Hospital	☐ I have taken a tour or reviewed the location.
☐ Birth center	☐ I know where to check in.
☐ Home birth	☐ I know what to bring.
☐ Other: _____	☐ I have reviewed relevant policies.

Address / Location	_____
Main Phone	_____
Check-In Instructions	_____
Questions for the Location	_____

What I want to ask before labor

My Support Team

Primary Support Person	Additional Support
■ Name: _____	■ Name: _____
■ Relationship: _____	■ Relationship: _____
■ Phone: _____	■ Phone: _____
■ Preferred role: _____	■ Role: _____

Support preferences

■ Please explain changes and important decisions clearly.

■ I would like my support person involved in communication when appropriate.

■ I would like help remembering my preferences if I am overwhelmed.

■ I would like support with comfort measures and position changes.

■ Other: _____

Labor Environment Preferences

Think about the atmosphere that helps you feel comfortable, informed, and supported.

Environment	Communication
☐ Dim or soft lighting	☐ Explain procedures before they happen
☐ Quiet environment when possible	☐ Give me time to ask questions
☐ Music	☐ Use simple, clear language
☐ Minimal interruptions when possible	☐ Include my support person when appropriate
☐ Privacy when possible	☐ Tell me when the plan changes

Personal preferences

Comfort & Relaxation Preferences

Mark the comfort strategies you would like to discuss with your healthcare team and support person.

Comfort Ideas	Support I Would Like
☐ Breathing or relaxation exercises	☐ Encouragement
☐ Massage or counter-pressure	☐ Quiet reassurance
☐ Warm shower or bath, if available	☐ Help changing positions
☐ Birth ball or other positioning aids, if available	☐ Hydration reminders, if permitted
☐ Heat or cold for comfort, if appropriate	☐ A calm presence

What helps me feel calm?

Movement & Position Preferences

Discuss which movement and positions may be appropriate for you based on your circumstances and your care setting.

Positions or movement I would like to discuss
☐ Walking or standing
☐ Sitting or using a birth ball
☐ Side-lying
☐ Hands-and-knees
☐ Supported squatting
☐ Changing positions as tolerated and permitted
☐ Other: _____

Questions for my healthcare team

Pain Relief Preferences

Pain management options vary by person, care setting, and medical circumstances. Use this page to record what you want to learn about and discuss with your healthcare team.

Comfort-Based Options	Medication / Anesthesia Topics
■ Breathing and relaxation	■ What options are available?
■ Movement and position changes	■ When are they typically offered?
■ Massage or counter-pressure	■ What should I know about each option?
■ Warm water, if available	■ Are there any timing or policy considerations?
■ Other: _____	■ Questions: _____

My questions and preferences

Monitoring & Procedures — Questions & Preferences

Use this page to prepare questions about monitoring, examinations, IV access, and other procedures that may be part of your care. Your healthcare team can explain what is recommended or required in your situation.

Topics I want to discuss
☐ Fetal monitoring
☐ Blood pressure and other routine checks
☐ IV access or fluids
☐ Cervical examinations
☐ Induction or augmentation, if relevant
☐ Other procedures: _____

Questions I want answered

Labor & Birth Preferences

During Labor	During Birth
■ I would like updates about progress.	■ Preferred birth positions to discuss
■ I want to ask questions before decisions when time allows.	■ Who I would like present
■ I would like my support person included when appropriate.	■ How I would like information explained
■ I would like to change positions when permitted.	■ Preferences for photos or video, if permitted
■ Other: _____	■ Other: _____

My personal birth preferences

Pushing & Birth Position Preferences

Birth positions and pushing approaches may depend on your health, the baby's condition, and the care setting. Use this page to record preferences you would like to discuss.

Preferences to discuss
☐ Position options during pushing
☐ Coaching preferences
☐ Quiet or focused environment
☐ Encouragement from my support person
☐ Mirrors or visual aids, if available
☐ Other: _____

Questions for my healthcare team

Immediate Newborn Preferences

Talk with your healthcare team about what may be possible immediately after birth and what may need to change based on the baby's condition or hospital policy.

First Moments	Routine Care Topics
☐ Skin-to-skin contact	☐ Newborn measurements
☐ Time to meet and bond with baby	☐ Vitamin K
☐ Support person involvement	☐ Eye care
☐ Photos, if permitted	☐ Newborn screening
☐ Quiet environment when possible	☐ Other questions: _____

My newborn preferences and questions

Skin-to-Skin Preferences

My preferences

- I would like to discuss immediate or early skin-to-skin contact.
- I would like my support person to understand my preference.
- If I cannot do skin-to-skin, I would like to ask whether my support person can, if appropriate.
- I would like to know how routine care can be coordinated with my preferences.
- Other: _____

Questions for my care team

Feeding Preferences

Choose the options you would like to discuss. Feeding plans can change, and your healthcare team can help you understand available support and options.

My feeding preference
☐ Breastfeeding
☐ Formula feeding
☐ Combination feeding
☐ I am undecided and would like information
☐ Other: _____

Support I would like
☐ Lactation support, if available
☐ Information about feeding options
☐ Help with positioning or feeding techniques
☐ Information about formula preparation and feeding, if needed
☐ Other: _____

My questions

Cord & Placenta Preferences

Policies and available options can vary. Ask your healthcare team what is possible and what may be recommended in your situation.

Umbilical Cord Topics	Placenta Topics
■ Timing of cord clamping	■ What happens to the placenta?
■ Who may cut the cord	■ Are there hospital policies I should know?
■ Cord blood questions	■ Do I have any requests I want to discuss?
■ Other: _____	■ Other: _____

Questions and preferences

Cesarean Birth Preferences

This page can be used for a planned cesarean or as a backup plan if circumstances require a cesarean birth. Discuss your preferences with your healthcare team in advance when possible.

If a Cesarean Is Planned or Needed	After Birth
■ Who I would like with me, if permitted	■ Skin-to-skin preferences
■ How I would like information explained	■ Support person involvement
■ Music or calming preferences, if permitted	■ Feeding preferences
■ Photos, if permitted	■ Bonding preferences
■ Other: _____	■ Other: _____

Questions for my healthcare team

If My Birth Plan Changes

Labor and birth can be unpredictable. Use this page to describe how you would like your team to communicate if circumstances change.

When plans change, I would like
☐ Clear explanations of what is happening.
☐ Information about available options when time allows.
☐ My questions answered as clearly as possible.
☐ My support person included when appropriate.
☐ My preferences considered whenever it is safe and possible.
☐ Reassurance that changing the plan does not mean I have failed.

What I want my support team to remember

Questions for My Healthcare Team

Before labor

- Which parts of my birth preferences should I discuss in advance?
- What are the policies at my birth location?
- Which comfort and pain-relief options are available?
- What should I know about monitoring and procedures?
- What should I know about newborn care and feeding?

My answers / follow-up questions

Important Contacts

Contact	Name	Phone	Notes
Healthcare Provider			
Birth Location			
Primary Support Person			
Additional Support			
Other			

Additional contact notes

Birth Plan Summary

Use this page as your quick-reference summary. Keep it concise and share it with your support person and healthcare team.

My name	_____
Due date	_____
Birth location	_____
Primary support person	_____
Top 3 priorities	1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____
Comfort preferences	_____
Pain relief preferences	_____
Newborn preferences	_____
Feeding preference	_____
If plans change	_____

One thing I most want my team to know

My Personal Notes

Use these pages for thoughts, questions, reminders, or anything else you want to remember.

Notes

My Personal Notes

Notes

Final Birth Preferences Checklist

Before your due date, review your workbook and update anything that has changed.

Ready-to-Share Checklist
■ I reviewed my birth preferences.
■ I discussed important questions with my healthcare team.
■ I reviewed the policies of my birth location.
■ My support person knows my top priorities.
■ My contact information is up to date.
■ My newborn and feeding preferences are recorded.
■ I have a concise summary ready to share.
■ I understand that plans may need to change.

A Note for Your Birth Day

Your preferences matter, and flexibility is part of planning. Keep communication open with your healthcare team, ask questions when time allows, and give yourself permission to adapt as your birth experience unfolds.

Personal reminder
■ I can ask questions.
■ I can communicate what matters to me.
■ I can stay open to changes when needed.
■ I can focus on being supported and informed.

Medical Disclaimer

This workbook is intended for personal organization and communication. It is not medical advice and does not replace care from a qualified healthcare professional. Discuss your individual circumstances, options, and preferences with your healthcare team.